Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Tuesday, 13 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Drizzle	Overcast	Drizzle	Rain
20° 15°	18° 12°	17° 12°	17° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Reform party has announced a radical plan to suspend the UK's asylum system for up to five years if they come to power.**

Under the proposals, all new asylum applications would be rejected, and existing ones voided. Anyone currently claiming asylum would be marked for deportation.

POLITICS · UK

2 **The trial of actor and comedian Russell Brand has begun in court, where he faces charges of rape and sexual assault.**

The 51-year-old denies allegations of rape and sexual assault brought by six different women. The proceedings are expected to be closely watched.

CRIME · UK

3 **A police officer reportedly dismissed a murderer's threats as 'empty' before a fatal arson attack that killed a family.**

PC Gemma Quinn allegedly did not believe it necessary to arrest Zak Bolland after Michelle Pearson's 999 call. This comes out during an ongoing inquiry.

POLICE · UK

4 **The UK's AI minister has issued a stark warning, stating it's 'likely' that the country's cyber defences will be breached.**

Kanishka Narayan revealed that the government plans to use advanced AI technology to strengthen the UK's protection against cyber attacks. The threat is considered significant.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

5 **Plans to tackle violence in the wake of the Southport attack have reportedly been shelved due to a lack of funding.**

An inquiry heard that responses outlined by the Home Office after the attack would require more money than currently available. This raises concerns about public safety.

CRIME · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Sacha Baron Cohen is set to grace the West End stage, starring in a new play by none other than Quentin Tarantino!**

The 'Borat' star expressed his delight at working with the 'Pulp Fiction' director on the show, titled 'The Popinjay Cavalier'. It's sure to be a hot ticket!

ON AIR — Sacha Baron Cohen and Quentin Tarantino working together! What do you think this play will be like?

THEATRE · COMING UP

2 **Robert Pattinson's new film 'Primetime' sees him portray the real-life host of the hit American TV show, 'To Catch a Predator'.**

The actor takes on the role of the host who hunted predators, bringing a fascinating true story to the big screen. It sounds like a gripping watch.

ON AIR — Robert Pattinson in a true-crime drama about hunting predators – does that sound like your kind of film?

FILM · COMING UP

3 **A significant sculpture by Barbara Hepworth, inspired by the Cornish landscape, is expected to fetch up to £8 million at auction.**

The post-war piece is set to go under the hammer, attracting considerable interest from art collectors. It could be a record-breaking sale for the artist.

ON AIR — £8 million for a sculpture! What's the most you'd ever spend on a piece of art?

ART · COMING UP

4 **US singer-songwriter Ashe has revealed the personal story behind her international smash hit, 'Stop The Wedding'.**

She admitted she was too scared to cancel her own wedding, and that experience became the inspiration for the popular song. It's a relatable tale for many.

ON AIR — Have you ever been in a situation where you felt you couldn't back out of something, even if you wanted to?

MUSIC · NOW

5 **HMV is planning to close its Oxford Street store after just three years, but promises to find a new West End home.**

The music retailer stated its current site is 'unviable' but is actively searching for a new location in London's iconic West End. Fingers crossed they find a new spot soon!

ON AIR — HMV leaving Oxford Street again – do you still buy physical music, or is it all streaming for you now?

RETAIL · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Arsenal manager Mikel Arteta has confirmed injuries to Piero Hincapie and Martin Zubimendi during a post-match training session.**

Arteta described the situation as 'far from ideal' for the club. The timing of these injuries will be a blow to their squad ahead of upcoming fixtures.

> ON AIR — Injuries in a post-match training session – is that just bad luck, or should clubs be reviewing their recovery routines?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Great Britain's Matt Richardson has been withdrawn from next week's World Track Cycling Championships.**

Reports suggest Richardson is currently under investigation for misconduct. This will be a significant disruption to the GB squad's preparations.

> ON AIR — A withdrawal from the World Championships due to misconduct allegations – how much do these off-track issues affect team morale?

CYCLING · UK

3 **The DP World Tour has announced it will not allow LIV Golf players to compete in its events during the 2027 season.**

This decision signals a continued divide in the world of professional golf. It will force players to make choices about which tours they wish to prioritise.

> ON AIR — Another twist in the LIV Golf saga! Do you think these bans are good for the sport, or do they just create more division?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

4 **Manchester United are reportedly eyeing Atletico Madrid's Giuliano Simeone, according to Tuesday's transfer gossip.**

Meanwhile, Chelsea are said to be willing to meet Bournemouth's asking price for Alex Scott. Premier League clubs are also interested in Inter's Aleksandar Stankovic.

> ON AIR — Giuliano Simeone to Man Utd – do you think he'd be a good fit, or are there other players they should be targeting?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Former Manchester City striker Imre Varadi praised fans for bringing 'fun back' by waving inflatable bananas at Anfield.**

Varadi described the sight as 'brilliant to see' and felt it added a lot of enjoyment to the atmosphere. It seems to have been a popular throwback for many supporters.

> ON AIR — Inflatable bananas at the football – a bit of harmless fun, or a distraction from the game itself?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new study suggests that the satisfying sound of a perfectly buttered crumpet hitting a warm plate might actually boost your mood.**
Researchers observed participants experiencing a small but noticeable lift in spirits when presented with this particular kitchen symphony. It seems the anticipation and comfort of a good crumpet are truly powerful!

2 **British pet owners are increasingly creating miniature 'adventure parks' in their gardens for their furry friends.**
From tiny obstacle courses for guinea pigs to elaborate climbing frames for cats, owners are getting creative to keep their pets entertained and active outdoors.

3 **The calming art of 'gentle cloud-gazing' is being rediscovered as a simple way to de-stress and reconnect with nature.**
Apparently, taking a few moments to watch the shapes drift by can be surprisingly meditative, helping to quiet a busy mind and spark a little bit of imagination.

4 **A quirky trend sees people sharing photos of their 'most peculiar supermarket finds' that made them smile.**
Think unusually shaped vegetables, oddly specific products, or just a funny typo on a label – the little things that add a bit of unexpected joy to the weekly shop.

5 **The delightful scent of 'freshly baked bread wafting down the street' is being celebrated as one of life's simple pleasures.**
Local bakeries are reporting an increase in appreciative comments from passers-by, proving that some smells are universally comforting and wonderfully inviting.

6 **A new appreciation for the 'humble British garden shed' is emerging, with many transforming them into creative havens.**
No longer just for tools, sheds are becoming tiny studios, peaceful reading nooks, or even miniature pubs, showcasing a wonderfully inventive spirit.

7 **The surprisingly satisfying feeling of 'successfully peeling a whole tangerine in one go' is bringing small triumphs to fruit lovers.**
It's a minor achievement, perhaps, but the joy of a perfectly peeled citrus without any messy bits is proving to be a quiet moment of daily satisfaction.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GIVING THE PACKET A LITTLE SHAKE TO HEAR THE RATTLE, HOPING FOR A 'GOOD SOLID BISCUIT' SOUND!

Q **Our survey said that over 75% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a new jar of pickles, especially if they're a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: TAKING A DEEP SNIFF OF THE BRINE THE MOMENT THE LID IS OPENED, JUST TO 'APPRECIATE THE AROMA'!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' just instantly makes you feel cosy or happy – maybe the distant chime of an ice cream van, the gentle purr of a kettle, or the familiar clatter of cutlery being put away after dinner?**
  What's that one sound that, for you, is the ultimate audio comfort blanket, and what lovely memories does it bring back?

- **We all have that 'one specific item of stationery' that we absolutely adore – maybe a particular pen that writes just perfectly, a lovely notebook that feels special, or even a favourite quirky rubber.**
  What's your go-to stationery item that brings a little spark of joy to your desk, and why is it so indispensable to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the common garden snail can sleep for up to five years at a time without waking?

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar.
- A pineapple is not a single fruit, but rather a collection of many individual berries fused together.
- The inventor of the Pringle, Fredric Baur, requested to be buried in one of the iconic cans.
- The Eiffel Tower can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to the expansion of the iron in the heat.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES TUE 13 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 286 of the year, 79 days left in 2026. Today Azerbaijani Railway Day (Azerbaijan); Christian feast day: Blessed Alexandrina of Balasar; Christian feast day: Chelidonia; Christian feast day: Edward the Confessor (translation). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Sammy Hagar, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1968 — Tisha Campbell-Martin, American actress and singer
- 1941 — John Snow, English cricketer
- 1944 — Robert Lamm, American singer-songwriter, pianist, and producer
- 1952 — Beverly Johnson, American model, actress, and singer
- 1961 — Rachel De Thame, English gardener and television presenter
- 1981 — Kele Okereke, English singer, songwriter, and musician
- 1947 — Joe Dolce, American-Australian singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1943 — World War II: Marshal Pietro Badoglio announces that Italy has officially declared war on Germany.
- 1908 — Margaret Travers Symons bursts into the UK parliament and becomes the first woman to speak there.
- 1892 — Edward Emerson Barnard is first to discover a comet by photographic means.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1946 — France adopts the constitution of the Fourth Republic.
- 1972 — Aeroflot Flight 217 crashes outside Moscow, killing 174.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1921 — Soviet republics sign the Treaty of Kars to formalize the borders between Turkey and the South Caucasus states.
- 1976 — The first electron micrograph of an Ebola virus is taken at the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention by Dr. F. A. Murphy.

- 2019 — Kenyan Brigid Kosgei sets a new world record for a woman runner with a time of 2:14:04 at the 2019 Chicago Marathon.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES WED 14 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 287 of the year, 78 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Angadrisma; Christian feast day: Fortunatus of Todi; Christian feast day: Joseph Schereschewsky (Episcopal Church (USA)); Christian feast day: Pope Callixtus I. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Cliff Richard, Indian-English singer-songwriter and actor
- 1980 — Amjad Khan, Danish-English cricketer
- 1980 — Ben Whishaw, English actor
- 1988 — Max Thieriot, American actor
- 1978 — Usher, American singer-songwriter, dancer, and actor
- 1968 — Matthew Le Tissier, English footballer and journalist
- 1990 — Jordan Clark, English cricketer
- 1978 — Steven Thompson, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1968 — Apollo program: The first live television broadcast by American astronauts in orbit is performed by the Apollo 7 crew.
- 2014 — The Serbia vs. Albania UEFA qualifying match is canceled after 42 minutes due to several incidents on and off the pitch. Albania is eventually awarded a win.
- 1966 — The Dutch Cals cabinet fell after Norbert Schmelzer, the leader of the government party, filed a successful motion against the budget, in what later became known as the Night of Schmelzer.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1994 — Yasser Arafat, Yitzhak Rabin and Shimon Peres receive the Nobel Peace Prize for their role in the establishment of the Oslo Accords and the framing of future Palestinian self government.
- 1981 — Vice President Hosni Mubarak is elected as the President of Egypt, one week after the assassination of Anwar Sadat.

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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